C2 Writing

Style, register and concision

Edit for precision: cut wordiness, control register and vary sentence rhythm.

At C2 level, good writing is about control. Every word should earn its place, and the register should match the reader exactly.

Cut wordiness

Wordy	Concise
due to the fact that	*because*
in the event that	*if*
at this point in time	*now*
make a decision	*decide*
it is important to note that	*(delete it)*

Control register

The same idea changes form depending on the reader.

Register	Example
Casual	*The plan fell apart pretty fast.*
Neutral	*The plan failed quickly.*
Formal	*The initiative proved unsustainable within a short period.*

Vary rhythm

Long sentences build an argument. Short ones land it. Alternating the two keeps a reader alert.

Avoid elegant variation. Do not change a key term just to avoid repetition. If you call it *the policy*, keep calling it *the policy*.

Practice

1. Make concise: Due to the fact that it was raining, the match was cancelled.
2. Make concise: We need to make a decision at this point in time.
3. Rewrite formally: Sales went through the roof.

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. Because it was raining, the match was cancelled. / The match was rained off.
2. We need to decide now.
3. Sales increased dramatically.